

## Voice2PDF Transcript

Hello, and welcome to this mini lecture today on the world's largest cruise ship, the Symphony of the Seas, owned and operated by Royal Caribbean International. She took three years to build at a cost of over £1 billion and offered her first passenger cruise on 7th April 2018 through the Mediterranean. The ship is currently located in the Caribbean offering short seven-night cruises from Miami to the Bahamas and back. So let's begin with some figures on the sheer size of this ship. First of all, the weight. She weighs 228,000 tons. Now onto the length. The ship is 362 metres long. This is equivalent to 3.5 football pitches. The ship has 18 decks and its overall height is 73 metres. This is nearly as tall as Big Ben. The ship has a large number of cabins, or as they are called on the ship, State Rooms, in total it has 2759 State Rooms. This means that it can carry a significant number of guests. The ship can easily accommodate families, couples, old or young, and the maximum capacity of guests on the ship at one time is 6,680. Obviously these guests need to be serviced day and night, so as well as all the guests, there are also 2,200 crew members. I'd like to give you some indication of the astonishing figures connected to food and eating. The kitchens produce a colossal amount of food per day. In fact, they create over 40,000 meals per day. These meals are served across the 22 restaurants on the ship, and on top of this it has a gigantic food shopping bill of just over a million pounds a week. The boat is packed with an unbelievable number of features such as a water park, a full-sized basketball court, an ice skating ring, a 1400-seat theatre, an outdoor aquatic theatre, rock climbing walls, and so on. The crowning glory of the ship's architecture is the split superstructure where the central section has been removed to create a tropical park containing over 20,000 tropical plants and trees. The ship is literally a mini floating city. It is claimed that cruising is great value because you pay one all inclusive price that includes everything. So let's see how much a 7-day Caribbean cruise for two people on the Symphony of the Seas would cost in August 2021. The starting price is £779 for an internal cabin without a window. If you'd like a room with a balcony and a CV, then this is £1,540. This price is doubled as each cabin is for two paying guests so this amounts to £3,000. It's important to note that a number of services are not included in the all-inclusive price. These are dining in the 20-speciality restaurants, shore excursions, the Spar and Sours, alcoholic beverages, non-alcoholic beverages and internet access. It is possible to pay for these services individually or by extra packages averaging at £25 to £50 each per person per day. Overall, the costs add up and with all the extras the bill is now £4,778. Of course, transfers to and from the port need to be included. In my case, this would be two return flights from London to Miami at £800. So the overall price, including VAT at £20, equals £6,600 for a 7-day holiday. This is the true price for an all-inclusive Caribbean cruise. OK, to sum up. Cruising has become an incredibly popular type of holiday with on average 30 million people globally going on cruise ships every year. It seems true to say that the ship itself has now become the destination. Thank you.